

To use an anchored volume profile on your charts, you first need to set it up correctly so that it displays actionable data about where trading volume is concentrated across different price levels.

Here is a step-by-step guide on how to apply, configure, and use the anchored volume profile:

1. Application and Setup

- **Find the Tool:** Open Trading View and look in your left-side toolbar. The "anchored volume profile" tool is located right above the brush icon 1, 2.
- **Enable Key Zones:** Open the profile's settings and ensure that the **Value Area High**, **Value Area Low**, and **Point of Control (POC)** are all enabled 1.
- **Optimize the Row Layout:** Go to the inputs and change the "row layout" to "number of rows," setting the value to **400** 1. The default 24 rows will leave your profile blurry and useless, but 400 rows will make it sharp enough to trade from 1.

2. Reading the Core Elements Once applied, the profile will appear as a histogram rotated 90 degrees directly onto your price axis, showing how many contracts were traded at specific prices 1, 3. You need to look for three main things:

- **Point of Control (POC):** This is the price level with the absolute most volume (the biggest bar) 1. It represents the market's center of gravity and is a level that the price frequently tends to return to 1.
- **The Value Area:** This is a highlighted range that contains roughly 70% of all trading activity 1, 4. It represents a balanced market where most buyers and sellers agreed on "fair value" 4.
- **High and Low Volume Nodes:** The profile will reveal **high volume zones** where the market consolidated, creating "sticky prices" due to trapped traders 4, 5. Conversely, you will see **low volume nodes** which act as the "fast lanes" of the market; because no one traded there, the price will rip through these thin spots very quickly 4.

3. Executing Trades Based on the Profile With the profile set up and readable, you can use it to execute the specific strategies we discussed earlier:

- **Predicting Trends with Shapes:** Analyze the overall shape of the volume profile—such as the **D-shape** (balanced), **P-shape** (bullish), **B-shape** (bearish), or **Thin profile** (explosive)—to decide whether to play simple rotations, buy pullbacks, short bounces, or follow strong momentum 6, 7.
- **Trading from High Volume Nodes:** Wait for the price to hit the edge of a massive high-volume node where thousands of traders are trapped 2, 5. If you see a trigger candle (like a hammer, doji, or shooting star) close with a volume spike, you can enter a trade and target the opposite edge of the profile 2, 8.
- **Trading Value Area Re-entries:** Use yesterday's Regular Trading Hours (RTH) profile to map out your value area 8. If the current session's price opens outside of this area but pushes back inside and shows "acceptance" (actual candles closing inside the zone), you can enter a trade targeting the complete opposite extreme of that value area 8, 9.